

SOC355: ASSIGNMENT 1

PERSONAL NETWORK ANALYSIS

For the past few weeks we have been reading about personal networks and social support. For this assignment you will analyze your own personal network. This assignment is due at the beginning of class on October 18th. It will be worth 25% of your final mark. You should submit your analysis (i.e. the paper) with your survey and calculations stapled on the back. You must upload your analysis to turnitin.com by 5pm on October 18th. Register in the course on turnitin using the classid and password.

You will begin by completing a social network survey. For this portion of the assignment you will be both survey respondent and interviewer. This will give you a taste of both what it's like to conduct a social network study and what it's like to be a respondent in a social network survey.

For the second portion of the assignment you will act as network *analyst*. You will calculate some simple measures of the composition and structure of your network and from this get a sense of what your network looks like. Then you will write a short analysis of what you find.

Step 1: The Survey

Completing personal network survey. This should take about 30-45 minutes.

Step 2: Describing Your Network

Calculate some simple measures of your personal networks' properties. Detailed instructions are provided. This requires no math beyond counting, adding, and dividing, but you'll probably want to use a calculator.

Step 3: Analyzing Your Network

Write a short paper in which you draw on what you've learned from the readings and lectures to analyze your findings.